



— PRODUCTBEACON RESEARCH · WEM RADAR

Salesforce buys Fin. AI pricing takes several forms.

Weekly summary · 12 September 2026

By Yohay Etsion · former NICE product leader (Recording/WFO), 2008–2021 · public sources only · full disclosure on the last slide





— THE DEAL

Salesforce completes its \$3.6 billion Fin deal.

- Salesforce completed the acquisition one quarter earlier than its guidance. Fin joins Salesforce AI Labs; Eoghan McCabe remains chief executive.
- Salesforce reports more than 30,000 Fin customer companies and a 76% average resolution rate.
- Fin lists \$0.99 per outcome. Agentforce lists \$2 per conversation and \$2 per Help Agent resolution.
- Business Insider also reports Salesforce talks to buy Listen Labs for around \$2 billion. Neither company commented; no agreement had been reached.

Our view: the key pricing question is whether Salesforce combines Fin and Agentforce charges or keeps them separate.

SOURCES Salesforce, 10 Sep · Business Insider, 9 Sep · TechCrunch, 9 Sep



— THE SEATS

Five9 expects fewer seats over time. Today, they grow.

- CEO Amit Mathradas says human-agent numbers are growing in line with 7% contact-centre subscription revenue growth.
- He expects compression over time: “Will there be compression in human seats? Sure.”
- At Goldman Sachs’ conference, CFO Bryan Lee reported AI revenue above \$150 million annualised and AI Agent gross margin “in the high 70s.”
- Management expects spending to shift from human seats to AI within the contact-centre budget.

Our view: AI changes the spending mix, but Five9’s current seat growth shows that displacement is not straightforward.

SOURCES Investing.com, 11 Sep



— THE PRICE

AI can be priced by outcomes, minutes or credits.

- Fin lists \$0.99 per outcome. Lorikeet charges platform and resolution fees without seats, and says customers do not pay for tickets they are unhappy with.
- Five9 charges for committed AI minutes, with higher rates for overage.
- Microsoft charges Copilot Credits for autonomous agents. Zendesk plans usage-based voice-translation pricing.
- Sierra, Decagon and Parloa do not publish list prices on their own sites.

Our view: compare the charging unit as well as the rate. Outcomes, minutes and credits measure different things.

SOURCES Fin · Lorikeet · Microsoft · Zendesk · Investing.com



— THE BOUNDARY

Microsoft includes assistance. Autonomous work costs extra.

- Dynamics 365 Contact Center lists at \$110 per user per month, paid yearly. Digital and Voice editions list at \$95.
- The seat includes Copilot, case and conversation summaries, email help and live translation among its listed features.
- Customer Intent, Customer Knowledge Management and Quality Evaluation agents each require separately sold Copilot Credits.

Our view: the listed tools that help a person are included in the seat; agents performing work independently incur separate charges.

SOURCES Microsoft



— CALIFORNIA

Three workplace-AI bills await the Governor.

- AB 1883 would prohibit employers from using AI surveillance to infer workers' emotions or collect neural data.
- SB 947 would prohibit sole reliance on automated systems for discipline or termination and require human corroboration when employers primarily rely on their output.
- SB 951 would require mass-layoff notices to identify jobs substantially displaced by AI or automation.
- All three have passed the legislature. None is signed or vetoed. They become law unless the Governor vetoes them by 30 September.

Our view: these bills would tighten the rules for workplace monitoring and automated employment decisions.

SOURCES California Legislative Information · Mintz via JD Supra



— WORKFORCE MANAGEMENT

LanguageLine workers report scheduling problems.

- LanguageLine interpreters told Capital & Main that workloads and schedules worsened after their employer deployed NiCE workforce-management software in 2025.
- Workers described unexpected break changes, shifts cut at short notice and as little as 15 seconds between calls at busy hours. Working conditions are cited in a unionisation campaign.
- LanguageLine says it has adjusted operations and things are “back to normal.” It attributes most schedule complaints to federal budget pressure.
- The employer sets schedules. The account does not establish vendor fault; no NiCE response is cited in the article.

Our view: workforce-management decisions need to account for working conditions as well as efficiency.

SOURCES Capital & Main, 7 Sep



— PREDICTIONS

Established platforms put pressure on specialists.

- ISG assessed 44 providers across eight guides. Cresta and Sierra appear on no Exemplary or Innovative list.
- Observe.AI adds specialised coaching capabilities, but supervisors still approve plans. No availability date was disclosed.
- Our prediction assessment: eleven supported, three weakened, two unchanged, and two still untested or not triggered.
- Outcome pricing exists, but three of five tracked autonomous vendors publish no list. The published price pages are undated.

Our view: specialist depth remains valuable, but the ISG rankings weaken the case that it alone protects independent vendors.

SOURCES ISG, 10 Sep · Observe.AI, 8 Sep



— SOURCES

Sources behind this week's news.

Company announcements, official records and reporting:

COMPANY ANNOUNCEMENTS AND PRICING

Salesforce · Microsoft · Observe.AI · Lorikeet · Fin · Zendesk · Sierra

OFFICIAL AND LEGAL SOURCES

California Legislative Information · Mintz

ANALYST AND PRESS REPORTING

ISG · Investing.com · Business Insider · TechCrunch · Capital & Main · PR Newswire

Source links and detailed citations accompany the full weekly summary.



— FULL DISCLOSURE

Plan for people and AI together.

AI pricing already combines several models. Five9's human seats still grow, and coaching tools retain supervisor approval. Buying and workforce decisions need to account for both people and AI.

→ **Read the full report**

productbeacon.agency/research/state-of-wfo-2026

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